Frank Ponce

AI & data strategy

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Data science master's student (Erasmus Mundus EDISS, Åbo Akademi) who builds with data and AI end to end: forecasting models, NLP pipelines, AI agents and dashboards that turn messy data into business decisions. Won Turku Energia's challenge at Since AI 2026 and reached the top 5 overall. Background in computer science, BI and evaluating AI systems, with a focus on using data and AI to shape business strategy.

SKILLS

ML & AI	**Machine learning** (LightGBM, gradient boosting), **forecasting** and backtesting, NLP (spaCy), LLMs, AI agent evaluation
Data & BI	**Python** (Pandas), **SQL**, Excel, Tableau, Power BI, web data collection, data cleaning and validation
Automation	**n8n** multi-agent workflows, REST APIs, GitHub Actions
Software	Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Salesforce, Jira, Git
Languages	English (fluent), Spanish (fluent), Portuguese (intermediate)

EXPERIENCE

AI Extern, Pfizer: AI Document Insights & Data Extraction · Extern (remote) — Aug 2026 – Present

- 10-week program on AI document intelligence for pharmaceutical PDFs: OCR and layout-aware extraction in Python, RAG, document classification and routing.
- Classified a vendor document file into quality, compliance and technical categories, catalogued its date formats, and found that its pages lacked machine-readable text, so structured extraction needed OCR first.

AI Extern, Wayfair · Extern (remote) — May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Built four n8n AI agents connected to product and social-trend APIs to collect, classify and structure data for trend discovery, competitor tracking and content strategy.
- Merged Amazon, Walmart and Wayfair product feeds into one dataset and generated a competitor report on pricing bands, whitespace gaps and suppliers.
- Consolidated agent outputs into a live category-intelligence dashboard combining trend signals, competitive benchmarks and AI-generated insights for category decisions.

Multimodal Agent Evaluator · Invisible Technologies (remote) — May 2026 – Aug 2026

- Audited AI agents' JSON tool-call outputs for hallucinations, wrong tool selection, parameter errors and failed multi-step workflows; produced labeled data and feedback to improve reliability.

Data Scientist, virtual work experience · CadetX — Ongoing

- Solo, 12 sprints: a hiring-intelligence pipeline reading 8,000+ Google, OpenAI, NVIDIA and Anthropic job postings as signals of their plans. Six sprints in: compliant collectors, a 212-skill NLP taxonomy, multi-year hiring trends and a competitor comparison.

Data Analyst Sprintern · StartupFIU, Miami — Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Cleaned and feature-engineered demographic and event-attendance data in Pandas and Excel, applied NLP to text data, and presented engagement insights.

Business Intelligence Intern · CDR Companies, Miami — Aug 2023 – Dec 2023

- Developed and tested features on the CDR Health **Salesforce** platform through Jira tickets; analyzed database objects and visualized them in Tableau.

PROJECTS

Tasehinta · 🏆 Winner, Turku Energia challenge · Top 5 finalist, Since AI 2026 — Nov 2026

- Team of five, 48 hours: an AI forecast of Finland's imbalance electricity price and a decision dashboard for traders. I built a LightGBM component on weather and real-time grid data and the final ensemble, 36.7 % better than the organisers' baseline.

VistaTrade · paper-trading and learning platform · vista-trade.vercel.app — 2025 – 2026

- Next.js and Python platform to learn investing with virtual money: live US prices, a tested trading engine, an 8-lesson course with hands-on tasks, and a LightGBM forecast evaluated against baselines in a 31-fold walk-forward backtest.

Reinforcement learning for post-disaster road restoration · published, *Reliability Eng. & System Safety* — 2026

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science, Erasmus Mundus EDISS — 2026 – 2028
Åbo Akademi University, Turku · Engineering of Data-intensive Intelligent Software Systems

BS Computer Science — 2021 – 2025
Florida International University, Miami · Magna Cum Laude, GPA 3.75